

(during work hours), and played poker several times a week. Margot's involvement in all these activities was carefully concealed from her husband.

Her gambling was threatening to destroy her marriage. Although rationally Margot knew that the odds of winning in gambling were very slim, she was emotionally compelled to continue. Finally, Margot agreed to allow Ernie to control the money. She also agreed to start attending Gamblers Anonymous meetings. This decision was a difficult one for Margot because she had to admit that her gambling had become addictive. She always assumed she could stop any time she wanted to do so. The fact that she couldn't stop and needed help was a tough admission. Margot succeeded in taking the first step, admitting she had a problem. Now the passage of time will show whether she can stay committed to a gambling-free life.

To improve her chances of giving up gambling, Margot needed to change her attitude about money as a savior from her boring life. Until she stopped believing that money is the only way her life could change, she would continue to be vulnerable. By looking at other ways to spice up her life, like choosing an interesting hobby or joining a social club, she would feel less of a need to gamble.

The attitudes we have can sometimes cause us to fail in our attempts to take control over our finances. If you recognize any of the following characteristics or attitudes in yourself, be on guard against them. Here are some common attitudes that can cause a financial plan to fail:

- Denial—Some people refuse to look at their financial condition in a frank and honest manner. They continue using available credit or borrow from friends to cover their perceived needs and refuse to admit a problem exists.

